

Fakeout — Game Spec

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Overview

Fakeout is a bluffing trivia game: players write fake answers to obscure fill-in-the-blank facts, then try to spot the real answer among everyone's lies. It plugs into the existing lobby and join flow, which this spec does not cover.

Setting	Value
Players	2-8 (3+ recommended)
Audience	Optional; audience can vote but does not score
Session length	About 15-20 min
Rounds	Round 1 (3 questions), Round 2 (3 questions), Final Fakeout (1 question)
Screens	One shared host screen (TV) + one phone per player
Input on phone	Text entry (lie), multiple choice (pick), like buttons

Core loop per question: the host screen shows a fact with a blank → every player types a believable lie on their phone → all lies plus the truth are shuffled onto the screen → each player picks the one they think is true → the game reveals each answer one by one, awarding points → scoreboard.

Winning: highest score after Final Fakeout. Ties are shared wins.

Game flow & state machine

The server owns one state machine per room; phones and the host screen only render the current state. Every timed phase advances early when all active players have submitted.

stateDiagram-v2

```

[*] --> INTRO
INTRO --> ROUND_TITLE
ROUND_TITLE --> CATEGORY_PICK
CATEGORY_PICK --> QUESTION
QUESTION --> LIE_ENTRY
LIE_ENTRY --> PICK_TRUTH
PICK_TRUTH --> REVEAL
REVEAL --> SCOREBOARD
SCOREBOARD --> CATEGORY_PICK: more questions this round
SCOREBOARD --> ROUND_TITLE: next round
SCOREBOARD --> FINAL_TITLE: rounds done
FINAL_TITLE --> QUESTION
SCOREBOARD --> WINNER: final done
WINNER --> AWARDS
AWARDS --> [*]

```

Phase	Timer	What happens	Advances when
INTRO	8 s (skippable by VIP)	Title card, one-line rules recap	Timer or VIP taps Skip
ROUND_TITLE	3 s	"Round 1" / "Round 2 — double points"	Timer
CATEGORY_PICK	15 s	One player (rotating) chooses from 3 random categories	Pick made, or random on timeout
QUESTION	5 s	Question with blank is shown and read (TTS optional)	Timer
LIE_ENTRY	45 s (60 s in Final)	Each player types a lie	All submitted or timer
PICK_TRUTH	20 s	Shuffled answers shown; players pick one	All picked or timer
REVEAL	~4 s per answer	Lies revealed one at a time, truth last	Sequence ends
SCOREBOARD	6 s	Ranked scores with deltas	Timer

Phase	Timer	What happens	Advances when
FINAL_TITLE	4 s	"Final Fakeout — triple points"	Timer
WINNER	8 s	Winner spotlight	Timer
AWARDS	8 s	Bonus titles, then Play again / Back to lobby	VIP choice

Round structure: Round 1 has 3 questions, Round 2 has 3, Final has 1 (7 total). With 5+ players, allow the host setting "Short game" = 2 + 2 + 1.

Category picker rotation: start with the lowest-scoring player; each question passes to the next lowest who hasn't picked yet this round. No category picker in the Final — it uses a dedicated final question.

Timeouts: a player who submits no lie contributes nothing (fewer options on screen). A player who doesn't pick scores nothing for picking but can still earn fool points.

Disconnects: a disconnected player keeps their score; the game does not wait for them. On reconnect they resume in the current phase.

Scoring

Players score by finding the truth and by fooling others; values multiply each round so late comebacks are possible.

Event	Round 1	Round 2	Final
Picked the truth	1,000	2,000	3,000
Each player fooled by your lie	500	1,000	1,500
Picked a house decoy (padding lie)	-250	-500	-750
Likes received	0 pts, tracked for awards	same	same

Edge cases and validation:

- **Lie matches the truth:** reject on submit with "That's actually the truth! Try another lie." Match after normalising: lowercase, trim, strip punctuation and leading articles (a/an/the), collapse spaces. Also reject if Levenshtein distance ≤ 1 for answers ≥ 5

characters, and check the question's `alternateSpellings` list.

- **Duplicate lies:** if two players submit the same lie (after normalising), show it once on screen. Anyone fooled by it awards fool points to **both** authors.
- **Can't pick your own lie:** your own answer is hidden from your phone's pick list.
- **Lie for me:** button on the phone fills the text box with an unused entry from the question's `suggestedLies`. The player can edit it; once submitted it counts as their own lie and earns fool points normally.
- **Fewer than 3 real lies:** pad the option list with house decoys from `suggestedLies` so the screen always shows at least 4 options. Picking a decoy costs points (table above); no one gains.
- **Max length:** lies are 1–40 characters; profanity filter optional (host setting, default on).
- **Final tie-break:** ties share the win; no sudden death.

Awards (end of game, 0 pts, just for fun): Biggest Liar (most players fooled), Truth Seeker (most truths found), Crowd Favourite (most likes), Most Gullible (fooled most often).

Screen layouts

The host screen is designed for 16:9 at 1920×1080 and read from across a room; phones are portrait, one action per screen, thumb-reachable buttons at the bottom.

Visual style: dark navy background (#14142B), hot-pink accent for lies (#FF4F8B), mint for truth (#3DDC97), gold for points (#FFC940). Headline font: a chunky rounded display face (e.g. Fredoka, weight 700); body: Inter. Minimum host text size 40 px; question text 64–72 px.

Phase	Host screen (TV)	Player phone
INTRO	Logo centre, tagline "Lie. Spot. Win.", 3 icon rules below	"Get ready!" + VIP-only Skip button
ROUND_TITLE	Huge "ROUND 1", multiplier badge ("x2") in round 2	"Look at the screen"
CATEGORY_PICK	3 category cards in a row; picker's avatar + name above	Picker: 3 big stacked buttons. Others: "[Name] is picking..."
QUESTION	Category label top-left, question centred with a glowing underline for the blank	"Read the question on screen"

Phase	Host screen (TV)	Player phone
LIE_ENTRY	Question stays at top; row of player avatars along the bottom that flip to a tick when submitted; circular timer top-right	Question (small) + text field + char counter + "Lie for me" + big Submit. After submit: "Lie locked in!" + waiting list
PICK_TRUTH	Question top; 2-column grid of answer cards (up to 9, incl. truth); timer; avatars tick as they pick	Vertical list of the same answers minus your own; tap to pick; then a thumbs-up per answer to like
REVEAL	One card enlarges centre; pickers' avatars stack on it; author stamp and points fly in	"Watch the reveal" + your running delta for this question
SCOREBOARD	Vertical ranked bars, avatar + name + score, green "+X" delta beside each	Your rank and score, big
WINNER	Winner avatar enlarged under a spotlight, confetti, final score	Winners: "You won!"; others: "You placed #N"
AWARDS	One award card at a time: title, avatar, stat	Your award (if any)

Key wireframes:

Host — LIE_ENTRY

```
+-----+
| ANIMALS                                ( 38 ) |
|                                         |
|   A group of flamingos is called a      |
|           -----                     |
|                                         |
|           Type a believable lie on your phone! |
|                                         |
| [Ana ✓] [Ben ✓] [Cat ..] [Dev ..] [Eli ✓] [Fay ..] |
+-----+
```

Phone — LIE_ENTRY

```

+-----+
| A group of flamingos |
| is called a _____.  |
|                      |
| [ type your lie    ] |
|           12/40     |
|                      |
| [   LIE FOR ME    ] |
| [   SUBMIT       ] |
+-----+

```

Host — PICK_TRUTH

```

+-----+
| A group of flamingos is called a _____. ( 17 ) |
|                      |
| [ FLAMBOYANCE      ] [ BLUSH          ] |
| [ PARADE           ] [ PINKERY        ] |
| [ STILT            ] [ CONGREGATION    ] |
|                      |
| [Ana ✓] [Ben ..] [Cat ✓] [Dev ..] [Eli ✓] [Fay ✓] |
+-----+

```

Host — REVEAL (one answer at a time)

```

+-----+
|           [ PINKERY ] |
| picked by: (Ben) (Dev) |
|                      |
| IT'S A LIE!  written by (Cat) +1,000 |
+-----+

```

Accessibility: colour is never the only signal (truth also gets a ✓ icon and the word TRUTH); all phone buttons ≥ 48 px tall; support reduced-motion (see Animations).

Animations & audio

Animations are short and bouncy (spring easing, 250–600 ms) so the pace stays fast; the reveal is the one place to build suspense. All timings are host-screen unless noted.

Moment	Animation	Duration	Sound
Phase transition	Current content slides out left, next slides in from right	400 ms	Soft whoosh
Round title	Text scales 0→1.2→1 with overshoot; multiplier badge stamps in with a shake	800 ms	Drum hit + stamp
Category cards	Cards deal in from bottom, 100 ms stagger; chosen card flips and zooms to fill screen	600 ms + 500 ms	Card flick, then ding
Question appear	Words type on left→right; blank underline draws itself last and pulses	~1.5 s	Typewriter ticks
Player submits	Avatar flips (Y-axis 180°) to a tick face, small bounce	300 ms	Pop
Timer	Ring depletes smoothly; last 10 s turns red and pulses each second	continuous	Tick each second in last 5 s
Answers shown	Cards pop in (scale 0.6→1, fade), 80 ms stagger, random order	~1 s total	Bubble pops
Phone: pick made	Selected option fills with accent colour, others dim to 40%	200 ms	Haptic tap (navigator.vibrate(30))

Moment	Animation	Duration	Sound
Reveal: lie card	Card grows to centre; pickers' avatars drop onto it one by one (120 ms stagger); "IT'S A LIE!" stamp slams in rotated -8°; author avatar slides in; "+points" floats up in gold to author	~3.5 s	Suspense riser → buzzer → cha-ching
Reveal: unpicked lies	Skipped entirely (not revealed) to keep pace	—	—
Reveal: truth (always last)	Screen dims, 1 s pause, card glows mint, "THE TRUTH" banner, confetti burst from card, finders' avatars bounce, "+points" floats to each	~4 s	Drumroll → fanfare
Nobody found truth	Truth reveals with a sad trombone and grey confetti	~3 s	Sad trombone
Scoreboard	Bars start at previous score, grow to new score; rows re-sort with FLIP animation	1.2 s	Rising blips per row
Winner	Spotlight sweeps then locks on winner; full-screen confetti; crown drops onto avatar	3 s	Crowd cheer
Award cards	Card flips in, stat counts up from 0	1 s each	Chime

Reveal order: lies ordered by fewest pickers to most, truth always last. Lies nobody picked are skipped.

Reduced motion: when `prefers-reduced-motion` is set (or host toggle), replace slides/scales with 200 ms fades, disable confetti and shakes, keep all text and timing.

Audio settings: separate music and SFX volume sliders on the host; background loop per phase (lobby-style loop in LIE_ENTRY, tensor loop in PICK_TRUTH). Phones play no sound by default, haptics only.

Suggested libs: CSS transitions/keyframes for most; Framer Motion (if React) for FLIP reorder; canvas-confetti for confetti; Howler.js for audio.

Data model & events

Questions live in a JSON file; the server holds game state and broadcasts a filtered view to host and each phone. The truth is never sent to phones before the reveal.

Question format

```
{
  "id": "q001",
  "category": "Animals",
  "prompt": "A group of flamingos is called a _____. ",
  "answer": "flamboyance",
  "alternateSpellings": ["flamboyancy"],
  "suggestedLies": ["blush", "parade", "pinkery", "stilt"],
  "isFinal": false
}
```

Game state (server)

```
type Phase = 'INTRO' | 'ROUND_TITLE' | 'CATEGORY_PICK' | 'QUESTION' | 'LIE_ENTRY'
  | 'PICK_TRUTH' | 'REVEAL' | 'SCOREBOARD' | 'FINAL_TITLE' | 'WINNER' | 'AWARDS';

interface GameState {
  phase: Phase;
  round: 1 | 2 | 3; // 3 = Final
  questionIndex: number; // within round
  deadline: number | null; // epoch ms, clients render timer from this
  usedQuestionIds: string[];
  current?: {
    question: Question;
    pickerId?: string;
    categoryOptions?: string[];
    lies: Record<playerId, string>;
    options: { id: string; text: string; authors: playerId[]; isTruth:
boolean; isDecoy: boolean }[];
```

```

    picks: Record<playerId, optionId>;
    likes: Record<playerId, optionId[]>;
  };
  players: Record<playerId, { name: string; avatar: string; score: number;
    stats: { fooled: number; truths: number; likes: number; gotFooled: number
  } }>;
}

```

Events (names suggested; adapt to your existing socket layer)

Direction	Event	Payload
Server → all	fakeout:state	Filtered GameState (phones never receive isTruth or authors until REVEAL)
Phone → server	fakeout:pickCategory	{ category }
Phone → server	fakeout:submitLie	{ text }
Server → phone	fakeout:lieRejected	{ reason: 'isTruth' 'tooLong' 'profanity' 'empty' }
Phone → server	fakeout:lieForMe	{ } → server replies { suggestion }
Phone → server	fakeout:pick	{ optionId }
Phone → server	fakeout:like	{ optionId } (toggle)
Host → server	fakeout:revealStepDone	{ step } — host drives reveal pacing
VIP → server	fakeout:skipIntro, fakeout:playAgain, fakeout:backToLobby	{ }

Question selection: draw categories from questions not in `usedQuestionIds` (persist across sessions in the room if possible). Final question is drawn from the `isFinal: true` pool.

Question bank

The starter bank holds 29 regular questions across 8 categories plus 3 Final Fakeout questions, enough for 3 full games without repeats. All are original prompts built on real, checkable facts; suggested lies double as "Lie for me" text and house decoys.

Writing new questions: pick a true fact that sounds made up, blank out one short answer (1-3 words), make sure several plausible fakes exist, and avoid answers that are guessable from the sentence's grammar (write "a(n)" rather than "an").

ID	Category	Prompt	Answer	Suggested lies
q001	Animals	A group of flamingos is called a _____.	flamboyance	blush, parade, pinkery, stilt
q002	Animals	A group of owls is called a _____.	parliament	wisdom, hoot, council, library
q003	Animals	A baby puffin is called a _____.	puffling	puffkin, cheeper, pufflet, fluffin
q004	Animals	Wombat poop comes out shaped like _____.	cubes	stars, spirals, pyramids, coins
q005	Animals	Koalas have _____ so similar to humans' they could confuse a crime scene.	fingerprints	footprints, teeth marks, voices, blood types
q006	Animals	A garden snail's mouth contains thousands of tiny _____.	teeth	tongues, hairs, suckers, eyes
q007	Food	In the 1830s, ketchup was sold in the US as a _____.	medicine	hair dye, paint, love potion, rat poison

ID	Category	Prompt	Answer	Suggested lies
q008	Food	Despite its name, the peanut isn't a nut but a _____.	legume	root, berry, seed pod, fungus
q009	Food	Honey found in ancient _____ tombs was still edible.	Egyptian	Roman, Viking, Mayan, Chinese
q010	Food	Before the 1600s, most cultivated carrots were _____.	purple (alt: yellow, purple and yellow)	white, blue, black, green
q011	History	Oxford University is older than the _____ Empire.	Aztec	Ottoman, Mongol, Inca, Russian
q012	History	Cleopatra lived closer in time to the _____ than to the building of the Great Pyramid.	moon landing	iPhone, printing press, Titanic, Eiffel Tower
q013	History	The 1896 war between Britain and Zanzibar lasted about 38 _____.	minutes	seconds, hours, days, cups of tea
q014	History	Napoleon was once chased off during a hunt by a swarm of _____.	rabbits	geese, bees, squirrels, frogs
q015	Science	A single day on Venus is longer than a Venus _____.	year	month, season, eclipse, orbit of Mercury
q016	Science	Bananas are naturally slightly _____.	radioactive	magnetic, alcoholic, luminous, caffeinated
q017	Science	The _____ is the only part of the human body with no blood supply.	cornea	earlobe, tooth enamel, fingernail, eyelash

ID	Category	Prompt	Answer	Suggested lies
q018	Science	A microwave oven was invented after an engineer noticed a _____ had melted in his pocket.	chocolate bar	candle, crayon, lipstick, gummy bear
q019	Words	The dot above a lowercase "i" is called a _____.	tittle	jot, speck, dimple, iota
q020	Words	The plastic tip on a shoelace is called a(n) _____.	aglet	ferrule, lacette, nib, tipple
q021	Words	The word "nerd" first appeared in print in a book by _____.	Dr. Seuss	Roald Dahl, Mark Twain, Enid Blyton, Charles Dickens
q022	Words	_____ is the only letter that doesn't appear in any US state name.	Q	X, Z, J, K
q023	Sport	Early golf balls were made of leather stuffed with _____.	feathers	horsehair, sawdust, wool, sand
q024	Sport	The 1900 Paris Olympics included live _____ shooting.	pigeon	turkey, duck, rabbit, balloon
q025	Places	Scotland's official national animal is the _____.	unicorn	Loch Ness monster, haggis, dragon, stag
q026	Places	Canada has more _____ than the rest of the world combined.	lakes	moose, maple trees, igloos, islands
q027	Places	The Eiffel Tower grows about 15 cm taller in summer because of _____.	heat (alt: thermal expansion)	tourists, paint, pigeons, rust

ID	Category	Prompt	Answer	Suggested lies
q028	Inventions	Play-Doh was first sold as a _____ cleaner.	wallpaper	carpet, window, oven, denture
q029	Inventions	The first product ever scanned with a supermarket barcode, in 1974, was a pack of _____.	chewing gum	cigarettes, batteries, playing cards, mints

Final Fakeout questions (isFinal: true , 60 s lie timer)

ID	Prompt	Answer	Suggested lies
f001	In 1386, a _____ was put on trial and executed for murder in Falaise, France.	pig	goat, cat, parrot, horse
f002	In 1932, the Australian military fought — and lost — a "war" against _____.	emus	kangaroos, rabbits, crocodiles, koalas
f003	In 1518, dozens of people in Strasbourg couldn't stop _____ for days.	dancing	laughing, sneezing, singing, hiccuping

Before launch, spot-check each fact against a reliable source; the phrasing here is kept deliberately cautious ("about", "most") where sources vary.